🎶 TRADITIONAL MUSIC AND IDENTITY

Music and Culture

Music is part of every culture.
Reflects traditions, history, and lifestyle.

🎶 MUSIC AND CULTURE

Music Shows Who We Are

Identity

Tells us where we come from.

Sindhi, Punjabi, Balochi, and Pashtun music.

Tradition

Keeps stories alive across generations.

Passes stories and traditions to future generations.

Community

Brings people together.

At weddings, Eid celebrations, and festivals.

CULTURE YOU CAN SEE

Symbols of Our Regions

Sindhi

Ajrak
Block-printed shawl

Sindhi topi
Embroidered cap

Punjabi

Pagri
Traditional turban

Phulkari
Colorful embroidery

Pashtun

Pakol
Woolen cap

Peshawari chappal
Leather sandals

Balochi

Embroidered dress
Detailed needlework

Mirror work
Shisha designs

Music Keeps Culture Alive
Reflects traditions and daily life.
Connects generations.
Respect our own and other cultures.
Listen
Explore
Respect

🎶 DIFFERENT STYLES, SOUNDS AND CULTURAL TRADITIONS
Music in
Pakistan
Classical
Folk
Sufi & Qawwali
Modern

🎶 DIFFERENT STYLES, SOUNDS AND CULTURAL TRADITIONS

Genres of Music in Pakistan

Pakistan has many different types of music. Each type has its own sound, instruments and cultural importance.

♪ **Some music is traditional, while other styles are modern.**

🎼 Classical Music

Traditional melodies and singing.

Famous artists: Mehdi Hassan, Ustad Amanat Ali Khan

Folk Music

Music connected to regional cultures and traditions.

Famous artists: Alam Lohar, Reshma

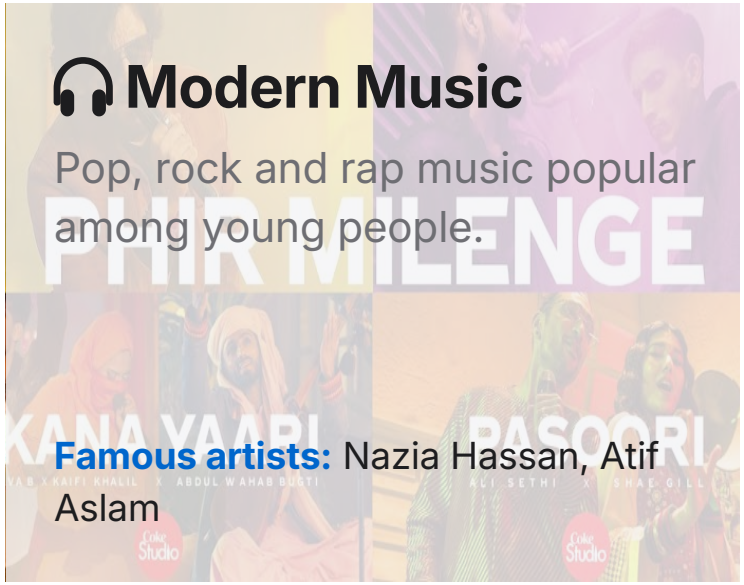
Sufi & Qawwali Music

Spiritual music expressing love and devotion.

Famous artists: Nusrat Fateh Ali Khan, Abida Parveen

🎧 Modern Music

Pop, rock and rap music popular among young people.



Famous artists: Nazia Hassan, Atif Aslam

Traditional Music of Pakistan

Classical Music

Traditional singing based on ragas and rhythm. Instruments include sitar and tabla.

Qawwali

A spiritual style of music performed by groups of singers, often accompanied by harmonium and tabla.

Punjabi Folk Music

Popular traditional music featuring instruments such as dhol and tumbi.

Regional Folk Music

Every region has its own musical traditions:

Sindhi music: Alghoza

Balochi music: Soroz

Pashto music: Rabab

Kashmiri music: Traditional folk instruments and songs

🎶 **Traditional music keeps Pakistan’s culture and heritage alive.**

🎧 MUSIC TODAY

Modern Music in Pakistan

Pop Music

Catchy songs with modern beats and melodies

Famous artist: Atif Aslam

Rock Music

Music featuring electric guitars, drums and energetic performances

Famous artist: Ali Azmat

Hip-Hop and Rap

Music based on rhythm, poetry and spoken lyrics

Famous artists: Young Stunners

Music Fusion

A combination of traditional Pakistani instruments and modern music styles

Famous artist: Abida Parveen

References

Sources for the genres, history and artists covered in this presentation.

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SUFI & QAWWALI MUSIC

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♪ A GENERATIONAL & PSYCHOLOGICAL EXPLORATION

The Evergreen Evolution

How Generations Relate to Music

From the complex storytelling of the golden era to the repetitive, vibey hooks of Gen Z, and why timeless classics still bridge every gap.

🕰️ Golden Era | 🎼 Timeless Classics | 📱 Gen Z

🎧 A GENERATIONAL & PSYCHOLOGICAL EXPLORATION

Understanding Music Listening: Then & Now

Classic Listening

Boomers & Gen X

- Appreciates deep, long-form stories
- Enjoys complex & layered music
- Connects with personal memories

vs

Modern Listening

Gen Z & Modern

- Loves catchy & instant hooks
- Prefers simple & repetitive beats
- Connects with vibes & relatable moods

🎶 **Both find deep joy in music, just in different ways!**

MUSIC THROUGH THE DECADES · 1950S–90S

How Pakistani Music Evolved

1950s–70s

The Golden Foundation

Ghazals, pop & PTV

Poetry and vocal artistry on Radio Pakistan, then youthful pop and PTV.

Noor Jehan, Mehdi Hassan, Lata Mangeshkar

1980s–90s

Bands & Pop Explosion

Rebellion and Sufi Rock

Disco Deewane (1981) and Dil Dil Pakistan (1987). Junoon fused Sufi poetry with rock.

Nazia Hassan, Vital Signs, Junoon, Nusrat Fateh Ali Khan

2000s–10s

Studio & Ballads

Atif Aslam and Coke Studio (2008) set the blueprint. Streaming made ballads like “Tum Hi Ho” easy to reach.

Atif Aslam, Arijit Singh

2020s

Indie & TikTok

A Gen Z wave

Indie artists and short-form video drive new hits, including global viral “Pasoori” (2022).

Abdul Hannan, Hasan Raheem

COGNITIVE SCIENCE

Why Simple & Repetitive Music Connects Easily

Processing Fluency

Listeners form positive feelings toward music that requires lower cognitive effort to process.

Mere Exposure Effect

Repeated exposure to catchy chorus lines rapidly increases liking and earworm retention.

Repetition Dynamics

Musical repetition pulls listeners in, making tracks easy to sing along with immediately.

The easier music is to process, the more we love it!

EMPIRICAL DATA

Scientific Findings on Song Evolution

Linguistic Complexity

Falling

IMPACT ON LISTENING

Low cognitive effort for passive multitasking.

Structural Repetitiveness

Rising

IMPACT ON LISTENING

Optimized to become instant earworms.

Readability & Vocabulary

Simpler

IMPACT ON LISTENING

Global accessibility for non-native listeners.

✨ **Simpler songs mean easier listening and a bigger reach!**

CONCLUSION & SYNTHESIS

The Symphony of Innovation & Memory

“Old music isn’t forgotten. It holds memories and soul that younger generations actively seek out.”

While Gen Z listens to modern repetitive music for fast moods, they turn to older classics for emotional depth and ancestral nostalgia.

Two Eras, One Shared Love of Music

Old Is Gold

Old songs offer a rich, full-course meal of lyricism and nostalgia, keeping generations connected to heritage.

Survivorship Bias: Only the absolute best old songs survived, making the past look exceptionally rich.

Modern Is Adaptive

Gen Z music serves a fast, digital world, offering immediate relatability, ambient vibes and catchiness.

Simple Is Not Shallow: Plain words in modern songs carry deep personal emotion without complex poetry.

🎧 MUSIC & THE BRAIN

Effects of Music on the Human Brain

Why music feels good, takes us back in time, and moves our bodies

✨ Feels good | ⏱ Time machine | 🫳 Hijacks your body

MUSIC & THE BRAIN

KEY POINTS

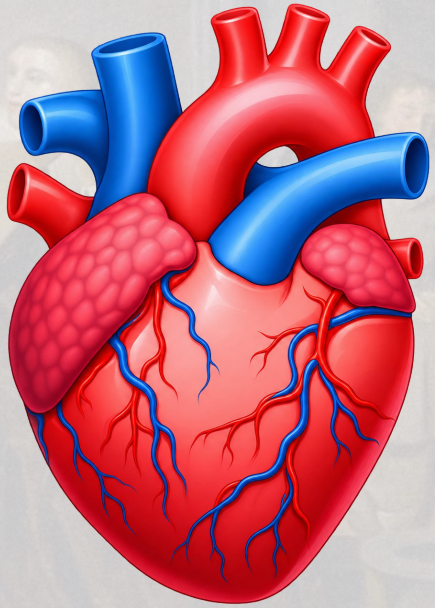
01

Why Music feels good to listen to

02

Why Music acts as a time machine

03



Why Music physically hijacks your body

✨ WHY IT FEELS GOOD

Why Music feels good to listen to

The Anticipation

Your brain is a pattern prediction machine. When a song is being played, your brain constantly tries to predict the next beat or drop. This anticipation releases *dopamine* in the brain, which gives you pleasure. This is why when you repeatedly listen to the same song, it doesn't hit the same anymore. This is because your brain has already learnt all the patterns, and there is nothing left to predict.

Brain Activation

Most activities (such as reading or solving math problems) use only one region of the brain. Music is an activity that engages every part of your brain, including auditory processing, emotion centers, motor regions and memory networks.

🧠 MEMORY & EMOTION

Why Music acts as a time machine

The Amygdala

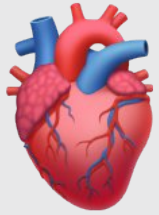
The Amygdala is a part of your brain that handles emotional responses such as sadness, fear, anxiety as well as feelings of reward & pleasure. Different songs make you feel emotional in different ways. Because music is so closely linked to emotional feelings, it causes you to remember whatever feelings you had back when you listened to the song for the first time.

Instant Snapshot Recovery

Because the melody, rhythm and beats of a song remain identical throughout the years, even if you listen to it years later it will instantly take you back to those moments.

BODY & MOVEMENT

Why Music physically hijacks your body



Heart Beat

When your ears hear a rhythmic beat, your body automatically aligns itself to the beat's tempo. Fast beats speed up your heart and force your nervous system to move. Slow beats pull your heart rate down, and force your muscles to relax.

Subconscious Movements

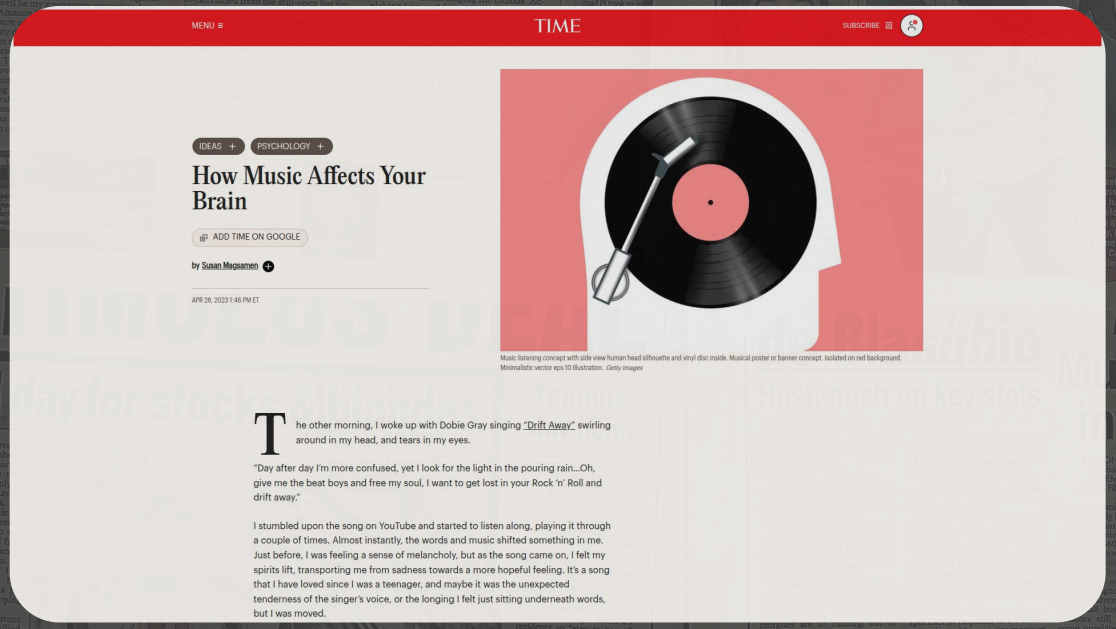
Normally, when you move, your brain has to think about it first and then send electrical signals to your body to complete the action. However, music bypasses this *"thinking barrier"* and goes straight to your brain's movement control center. This causes you to perform involuntary movements according to the music's tempo, such as bobbing your head or tapping your foot.

Sources

How Music Affects Your Brain

https://time.com/6275519/how-music-affects-your-brain/

An article by Time Magazine on the effects of music on the brain.



MENU ≡ TIME SUBSCRIBE

IDEAS + PSYCHOLOGY +

How Music Affects Your Brain

ADD TIME ON GOOGLE

by Susan Magsamen

APR 28, 2023 1:46 PM ET

Music listening concept with side view human head silhouette and vinyl disc inside. Musical poster or banner concept. Isolated on red background. Minimalistic vector eps 10 illustration. *Getty Images*

The other morning, I woke up with Dobie Gray singing "Drift Away" swirling around in my head, and tears in my eyes.

"Day after day I'm more confused, yet I look for the light in the pouring rain...Oh, give me the beat boys and free my soul, I want to get lost in your Rock 'n' Roll and drift away."

I stumbled upon the song on YouTube and started to listen along, playing it through a couple of times. Almost instantly, the words and music shifted something in me. Just before, I was feeling a sense of melancholy, but as the song came on, I felt my spirits lift, transporting me from sadness towards a more hopeful feeling. It's a song that I have loved since I was a teenager, and maybe it was the unexpected tenderness of the singer's voice, or the longing I felt just sitting underneath words, but I was moved.

Music and Your Brain

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gveDhZW-rUk&t

A podcast episode by neuroscientist Andrew Huberman on how music affects human beings, and how to use it to your advantage.

HOW MUSIC EVOLVED

Music and Technology

From vinyl to streaming to AI

Technology Shapes Music

Every new invention changes how music is made, shared, and heard.

01

Made

Studios, synthesizers, and software create the sound.

02

Shared

Records, files, and the internet move songs around the world.

03

Heard

Turntables, Walkmans, and phones decide where we listen.

From Vinyl to Streaming

Vinyl
Long-playing records arrive.

Cassette
Portable and recordable.

CD
Digital sound on a disc.

MP3
Songs become files.

Spotify
A whole library in your pocket.

Each step made music easier to carry and easier to get.

Streaming Changed the Deal

$10B

Paid out by Spotify in 2024, up from $1B in 2014.

1,000

Streams a year a track needs to earn royalties on Spotify.

~70%

Of surveyed European artists were unhappy with streaming income.

Great for listeners. For many artists, the pay is a real concern.

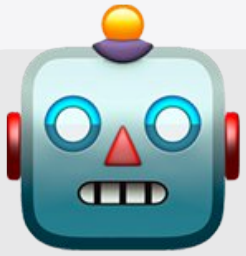
Sources: Spotify; International Artist Organisation survey

AI Generated Music

STEP 1

Prompt

Describe the genre, mood, and lyrics in text.



STEP 2

Model

A generative model trained on huge collections of recordings.

STEP 3

Song

A full track with vocals in under a minute.

🛠 Tools: Suno, Udio, ElevenLabs Music

Spotify allows AI music, encourages labeling it, and removes unauthorized voice clones.

What It Means for Artists

Opportunity

- Quick demos and new ideas
- Music tools open to beginners
- Licensed AI models built with label deals

Concern

- Models trained on songs without permission
- Voice clones and fake tracks
- A flood of uploads shrinks each artist’s share

⚖️ In 2024, major labels sued Suno and Udio. Some have since signed licensing deals, but the rules are still unsettled.

Music Keeps Evolving

Embrace

Use new tools to create and discover.

Think

Ask how AI music is trained and who gets paid.

Support

Credit and pay the human artists we love.

❤️ **Thank you for listening!**